The Five Good Emperors

After Domitian's assassination, he was succeeded by Nerva who had been his most trusted advisor. With Nerva came the founding of the Nervan-Antonin Dynasty that lasted between 96 – 192 CE. During this era, Rome saw a great expansion of its borders and increase in wealth. This progress is often attributed to its rulers who are commonly referred to as the Five Good Emperors. The five emperors of Rome in this period were Nerva (96 – 98 CE), Trajan (98 – 117 CE), Hadrian (117 – 138), Antoninus Pius (138 – 161) and Marcus Aurelius (161 – 180 CE). Because of these five emperors, the Roman Empire reached the heights of its power. The military had strengthened to a level the likes of which had never been seen before in the region. After Marcus Aurelius died, the last emperors of the Nervan-Antonin Dynasty were Lucius Verus and Commodus. Lucius Verus was the co-ruler with Marcus Aurelius until the emperor died. He has long been regarded as somewhat of a buffoon because of his foolish decisions. Commodus was the son of Marcus Aurelius and history portrays him to be one of the worst Roman emperors to ever live. In 192 CE, Commodus was strangled to death. His assassination was perhaps masterminded by Pertinax who rose to take power for himself.